

Corrugated Refrains

solo bass clarinet

Neil Thornock

for Kenneth Long

Corrugated Refrains

Commissioned by the
Barlow Endowment for Music Composition
at Brigham Young University

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Program Note

Corrugated Refrains was commissioned by the Barlow Endowment for Music Composition at Brigham Young University for clarinetist Kenneth Long. The impetus for the piece is best captured in the first word of the title, both as imagery (I'm thinking of corrugated tin rooftops) and as concept (a structural folding of materials). Throughout the work I explore several methods of folding the musical fabric as a means of strengthening the relationships between otherwise disparate types of material. The folding happens both on the large scale (the work is roughly a rondo in structure) and on several smaller structural levels. Even the oscillation between two pitches - whether rapid or slow - arise out of a highly localized concept of folding.

And then the imagery. I remember as a child seeing corrugated roofs. They bring to mind something strong and protective on the one hand, rough-hewn and dirty on the other. The sound of something hitting such a roof is crisp, clanky, sometimes with slappy reverberation, depending on the neighborhood. And while the stylistic statement of a corrugated roof is bold and masculine (although such roofs rarely arise out of stylistic considerations), underneath the roof may be housed - in my childhood neighborhood, at least - a significant portion of humanity.

Performance Notes

For the most part, the interpretation of this work should be at times explosive and at others mechanical. The precise rhythmic notation of the more complex passages - while it should be adhered to - may be taken with some liberty, but always and only to serve the extreme expressive ends of individual gestures.

✂ *quasi pizzicato* If possible, this is to be achieved with a quiet, well-defined slap tongue. If slap tongue is not possible, a crisp, quiet staccato may be used.

♪ *sotto voce*

↓ change to an alternate fingering of the note indicated

All trills are whole-tone trills with the upper auxiliary.

The indication **A tempo** always refers to a resumption of the most recently indicated metronome marking.

Quarter tones may be somewhat inaccurate in intonation and/or weak in tone quality, which is expected and desired.

For Kenneth Long
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$\text{♩} = 84$ Nervously, at times explosive

pp *f*

3 *ril.* *A tempo* *pp* *f*

6 *pp* *f*

8 *ril.* *A tempo* *Relaxed, funky*

11 *pp* *p f p f p f p f p f p f p f p f*

16 *p f p f pp f*

20 *mp* *f*

22 *p* *f* *more anxious* *p f p f p f p f*

25 *p f p f p f p f p f*

29 *p f mp*

31 *ff pp f*

33 *p ff* *frantic* *p f p f p f*

36 *p f p f p f p f p f p f p f* *accel.*

41 *p f p f p f p f p f p f* *accel.* **Presto!** *5 times!*

46 *p f p f p f ff*

50 *fff sub. p pp ff pp* *rit.* *♩ = 84*

54 *f mp pp* *rit.*

58 $\text{♩} = 63$

alt. fingering

pp

62

65

$\text{♩} = 84$ $\text{♩} = 112$

f *pp*

70 *f* *p* *ff*

$\text{♩} = 84$

73 *fff* *p*

76 *f* *p* *f* *p* *mf* *pp*

$\text{♩} = 63$

79 *pp*

84 *f* *mp* *pp* *accel.*

89 *ppp* *f* *pp*

93 *f*

96 *♩ = 84* *ff* *f* *p* *ff*

99 *quasi pizz. (see notes)* *ppp* *pp* *f* *p* *f* *pp*

103 *ff* *ppp*

107 *pp* *f*

110 *p* *f* *pp*

114 *pp* *f* *ppp*

All trills are whole step trills unless otherwise indicated.

119 *sotto voce* *fp* $\textcircled{2x}$

$\textcircled{2x}$ $\textcircled{5x}$

$\textcircled{6x}$ $\textcircled{2x}$ *f*

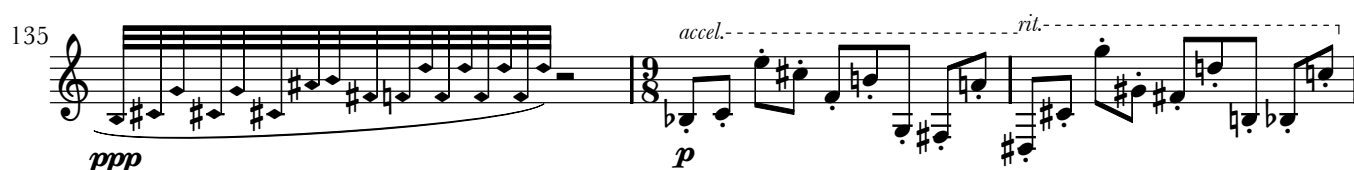
ppp *poco rit.* **A tempo** *f* *p* *ff* $\textcircled{3}$

124 *ad lib.* *p* *f* $\textcircled{3}$ *mp* *pp* *ad lib.*

$\textcircled{9x}$

126 $\textcircled{3}$ *ff* *p* *f* *p*

128 *pesante* *poco rit.* **A tempo** *f* *ppp*



154

f

157

mp

160

f

NO

162

f

164

fff

Prestissimo! (jagged rhythms)

167

ppp

fff

168 $\text{♩} = 120$

ff *pp* *ff*

171 *pizz.*

ppp *ff*

Cut some?

175

pp

178 $\text{♩} = 60$

ff *p*

182 $\text{♩} = 120$

ff

187 $\text{♩} = 144$

p *f* *p* *ff*

191 $\text{♩} = 60$

p

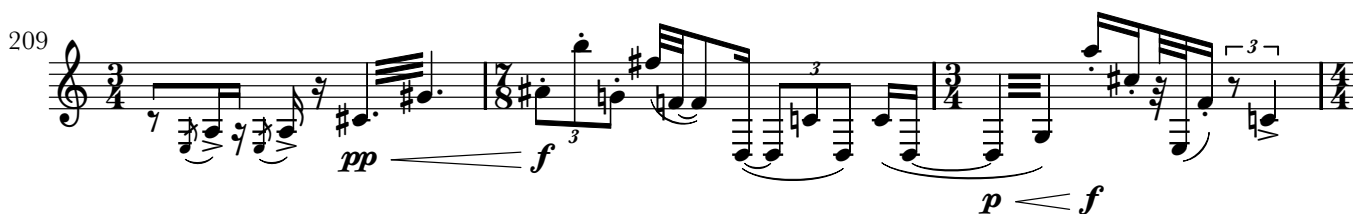
rubato, floating

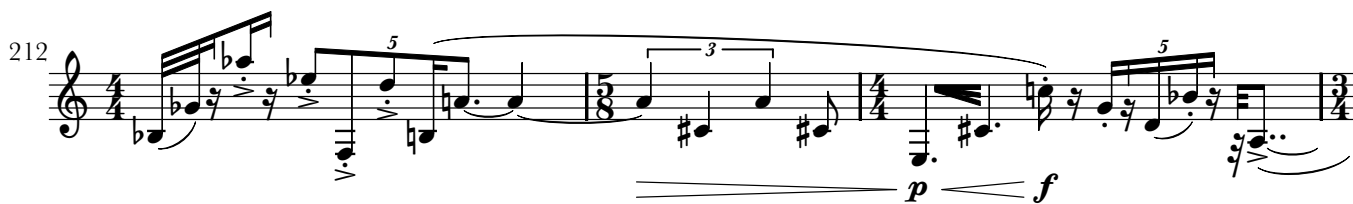
196  *pp*

198  *accel.* ♩ = 120 *ff*

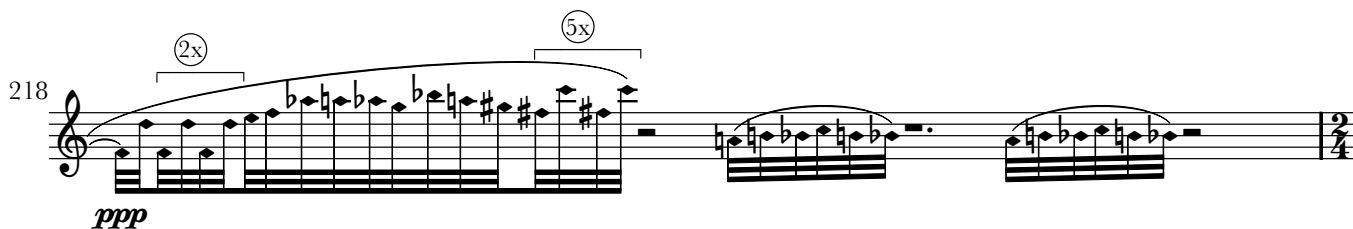
201 

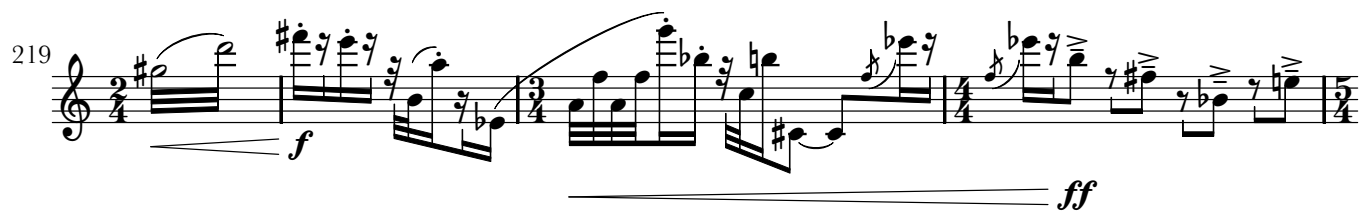
204  ♩ = 84 *fff* *f*

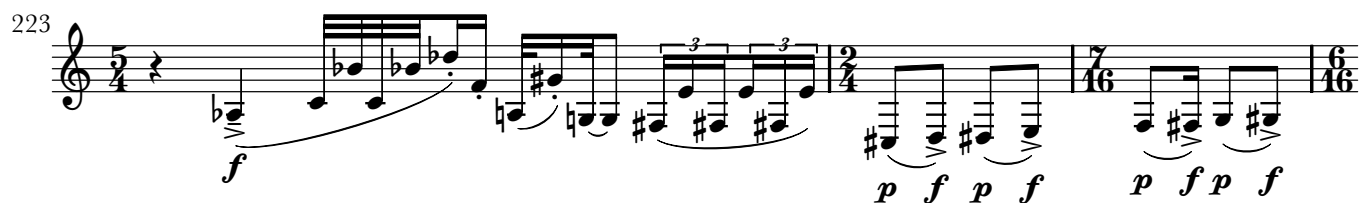
209  *pp* *f* *p* *f*

212  *p* *f*

215 

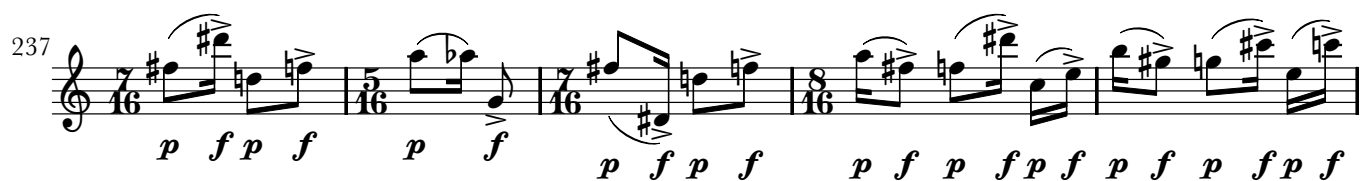
218  *ppp*

219  *f* *ff*

223  *f* *p f p f*

226  *p f p f* *p f p f* *p f p f* *p f p f*

231  *p f p f* *p f p f* *p f p f* *p f p f* *p f p f*

237  *p f p f* *p f* *p f p f* *p f p f p f p f p f p f*

242  *p f p f p f* *ff* *p f p f p f p f p f p f*

Presto $\text{♩} = 66$ Playful

246  *p f p f p f p f p f p f*

$\text{♩} = 84$

250 f p f p

252 f p mf p f pp

255 f p

260 **A tempo** f p **A tempo**

264 f pp p **A tempo**

269 f

273

277 pp

281

f

284

pp

289

293

f

298

f *p* *pp*

302

f *p*

306

ppp

310

Allegretto $\text{♩} = 60$